

md2pdf – Markdown to PDF CLI

Convert markdown and HTML files to crisp, professional PDFs with sensible defaults.

- Paper: US Letter (8.5" x 11")
- Margins: 0.7" all sides
- Font: Charter 11pt
- Engine: Pandoc + pdflatex

QUICK START

Installation

```
# Clone or download this directory cd md2pdf
# Install dependencies (one-time) chmod +x setup.sh ./setup.sh
# Link to your PATH (optional, for global access) chmod +x md2pdf.js ln -s "$(pwd)/md2pdf.js"
/usr/local/bin/md2pdf
```

Usage

```
# Single file md2pdf.js convert -i document.md -o ./output/
# Multiple files md2pdf.js convert -i file1.md file2.html -o ./pdfs/
# Entire directory (finds all .md/.mdx/.html files) md2pdf.js convert -i ./docs -o ./output/
```

REQUIREMENTS

Tool	Purpose	Installed via
Node.js 18+	CLI runtime	Homebrew or nodejs.org
pandoc 2.18+	Document converter	brew install pandoc
basictex	LaTeX engine + fonts	brew install basictex

SETUP DETAILS

setup.sh installs:

```
# Core tools brew install pandoc basictex
# LaTeX packages for PDF rendering tlmgr install collection-fontsrecommended # Charter font tlmgr
install geometry setpspace parskip titlesec
```

NOTE: First installation may take 5-10 minutes as basictex downloads and configures.

TROUBLESHOOTING

“pdflatex: command not found”

After running setup.sh, reload your shell:

```
source ~/.zshrc # or for bash: source ~/.bash_profile
```

“Charter font not found”

Ensure LaTeX fonts are installed:

tlmgr install collection-fontsrecommended

PDF output looks wrong

- Margins off: Edit letter-template.tex and adjust margin=0.7in
- Font not rendering: Verify Charter is installed with: `fc-list | grep -i charter`
- Pandoc errors: Check markdown syntax

FILE STRUCTURE

md2pdf/ ├── md2pdf.js # Main CLI script ├── letter-template.tex # LaTeX template ├── setup.sh # Dependency installer ├── README.md # This file └── package.json # Node dependencies

EXAMPLES

Example 1: Convert single markdown

`md2pdf.js convert -i report.md -o ./reports/` # Output: `./reports/report.pdf`

Example 2: Batch convert all markdown in folder

`md2pdf.js convert -i ./src/docs -o ./dist/pdfs/`

Example 3: Convert HTML file

`md2pdf.js convert -i index.html -o ./`

CUSTOMIZATION

Change Paper Size

Edit letter-template.tex:

Change Font

Replace Charter in letter-template.tex:

% Or any installed font

Change Margins

Edit the margin= parameter:

DEVELOPMENT NOTES

- Template variables: The LaTeX template supports Pandoc variables like *title*, *author*, *date*
- Input formats: Supports .md, .mdx, .html, .htm
- Frontmatter: YAML frontmatter is automatically processed

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